

Paper

Paper is made from linen or cotton fibers or wood pulp. To make paper less absorbent and create a surface that can hold washes and brushstrokes, size is added. Lighter weight papers have less size so may need to be

stretched first to keep them from buckling. You can buy paper with a variety of surfaces and in a range of weights, so try to buy single sheets of paper until you have decided which type suits you.

TYPES OF PAPER

There are three main types of paper surface: hot-pressed paper has a hard, smooth surface; cold-pressed, or NOT, paper has a slight texture; and rough paper has been allowed to dry without

pressing. Paper weights are given in lbs (pounds per ream) or gsm (grams per square meter). The choice ranges from light paper, which weighs 90 lb (190 gsm), to heavy 300 lb (638 gsm) paper.

Rough paper has a heavy texture. It is very versatile and good for a wide range of effects.

Cold-pressed paper is smoother than rough paper but is still textured. It is the best paper for general use.

Hot-pressed paper is very smooth. It is good for detail but is best avoided by beginners.

The right side of the paper has a watermark, but most good papers can be used on either side.

Paper is sold in sheets that measure 30 in (76.2 cm) x 22 in (55.9 cm).

Toned papers As watercolors are transparent, they work best on white paper, although most papers have a slight tint. Toned papers affect the color of the paint.

Watercolor blocks Blocks of paper are good for using on location, as you do not need a drawing board. They are glued on all four sides, so do not require stretching.

